

CASE ID: 202504710002b

EPISODE NAME: China Responds to 145% US tariffs

2025/04/11 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: Retaliation (16)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

Narrative:

On 2025/04/11, China escalated tension between Beijing and Washington by increasing their tariff rate on the US to 125%.¹ China's decision was a direct response to the US's imposition of 145% tariffs on all imported goods from China on 2025/04/10.²

The sanctions represented an escalation in the US-China trade war. In 2025/02, the two countries had traded 10%-15% tariffs and various other trade restrictions following president Donald Trump's inauguration.³ Further tariffs were implemented by both sides on 2025/03/04.⁴ Just before tariffs passed 100%, on 2025/04/2, China and the US had each raised rates to 34%.⁵

On 2025/05/12, the Chinese government agreed to reduce their tariffs as the United States would follow at the same time. Both nations agreed to keep a 10% blanket tariff and a 90 day suspension for the retaliation tariffs.⁶ Another round of negotiations on 2025/11/10 reduced Chinese countermeasures further.⁷ Some trade restrictions remain in place.

¹ Elyse Gumbiner. "Trump trade war escalates as China raises retaliatory duties on U.S. goods." *NBC News*, April 11th, 2025.

<https://www.nbcnews.com/politics/trump-administration/live-blog/trump-tariffs-live-updates-china-raises-retaliatory-levies-125-dollar-rcna200775>.

² Arendse Huld. "Trump Raises Tariffs on China to 145% – Overview and Trade Implications." *China Briefing*, April 11th, 2025.

<https://www.china-briefing.com/news/trump-raises-tariffs-on-china-to-145-overview-and-trade-implications/>.

³ Boak, Josh, et al. "Trump Puts Tariffs on Canada, Mexico and China, Spurring Trade War as North American Allies Respond." *AP News*, 2 Feb. 2025,

apnews.com/article/trump-tariffs-trade-china-mexico-canada-inflation-753a09d56cd318f2eb1d2efe3c43b7d4.

⁴ Boak, Josh, et al. "Trump's Long-Threatened Tariffs against Canada and Mexico Are Now in Effect, Kicking off Trade War." *AP News*, March 4th, 2025.

apnews.com/article/trump-tariffs-canada-mexico-china-643086a6dc7ff716d876b3c83e3255b0.

⁵ Gan, Nectar, and Liu, Juliana. "China imposes 34% reciprocal tariffs on imports of US goods in retaliation for Trump's trade war." *CNN*, April 4th, 2025.

<https://www.cnn.com/2025/04/04/business/china-us-tariffs-retaliation-hnk-intl>.

⁶ Joseph Stepansky. "Trump tariffs updates: China hit with 145% duties as Wall Street slides." *Aljazeera*, April 10th, 2025.

<https://www.aljazeera.com/economy/liveblog/2025/4/10/trump-tariffs-live-stocks-skyrocket-as-many-duties-paused>.

⁷ Huld, Arendse Qian Zhou. "US and China Reach Trade Concessions Following Trump-Xi Meeting: Outcomes and Implications." *China Briefing*, 10 Nov. 2025.

<https://www.china-briefing.com/news/trump-xi-meeting-outcomes-and-implications>